

Developer Handoff Prompt: Multiplayer Alien Shapeshifting Prototype

Project Summary

We are building a mobile-friendly real-time multiplayer open-world shapeshifting game.

Players are aliens in a persistent Memphis-inspired sandbox. They can shapeshift into world objects by touching them and completing a simple mini-game. The core gameplay is collecting physical money objects, combining money into larger money objects, stealing from other players, hiding loot, using objects cleverly, and creating funny revenge moments.

The game should feel simple, chaotic, social, and funny. It should not feel like a hardcore RTS, but object interactions should create strategy.

Important current state:

- The game already has a simple onboarding screen.
- Players spawn as aliens.
- Players can roam a small open world with some trees and houses.
- Other players are visible roaming around.
- Player position persists when leaving and returning.
- There is no collision detection yet.
- There is no shapeshifting yet.
- There is no money system yet.
- There is no death/respawn system yet.

The next goal is to build a **minimal quick prototype** that tests whether the core idea is fun before implementing the full game.

High-Level Game Pitch

Spawn as an alien at the landfill. Touch objects to shapeshift into them. Collect money stacks, combine them into bigger loot, steal other players' money, hide your stash, and use funny Memphis objects to trap, squish, explode, or outsmart other players.

There is no match timer. The world is always live and persistent.

Players can die, but death is not a harsh punishment. If killed, they respawn at the landfill dump.

No health bars. A player is either alive or dead.

Core Design Rules

1. No heavy UI

Avoid showing numeric stats during gameplay.

Use physical objects instead:

- Money stacks
- Money bags
- Vaults
- Crates
- Vehicles carrying loot
- Visible owner labels on loot

2. Every object must have a purpose

Every shapeshiftable object should do at least one of these:

- Generate money
- Carry money
- Hide money
- Steal money
- Kill another type of object
- Counter another object
- Block movement
- Explode
- Unlock access to an area
- Help escape
- Create comedy or confusion

3. Object counters should feel intuitive and funny

Examples:

- Car squishes alien.
- Tree kills car if the car crashes into it.
- Pothole wrecks car.
- Bus crushes car.
- Propane tank explodes when hit by car.
- BBQ smoker creates smoke cover.
- FedEx box hides near other boxes.
- Tow truck steals disabled vehicles.
- Tiger kills humans.
- Grizzlies bear kills tiger.
- Plane only kills smaller flying objects.

4. Death should be funny and recoverable

When a player dies:

- Their current form is destroyed or popped back into an object.
 - Their carried money drops.
 - They respawn at the landfill.
 - They do not lose permanent progress.
 - Death should create revenge, not rage.
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Phase 1: Minimal Quick Prototype

The goal of Phase 1 is to test the basic fun loop with the fewest systems possible.

Prototype Loop

Alien spawns → player shapeshifts → collects money → combines money → another player steals or kills them → dead player respawns → revenge chase begins.

Phase 1 Required Features

1. Basic collision detection

Add collision detection for:

- Player movement
- Trees
- Houses/buildings
- Vehicles
- Money objects
- Explosive objects
- Other players

This can be simple bounding-box or capsule collision. It does not need advanced physics yet.

2. Spawn point: landfill dump

Create one designated spawn area called **Landfill Dump**.

All new players and dead players spawn here.

The landfill should contain starter shapeshift objects:

- Trash bag

- Shopping cart
- Tire
- Small tree
- Rusty Altima
- Propane tank
- Road cone

For the first prototype, only some of these need to be interactive.

3. Player forms

Implement only these initial forms:

1. Alien
2. Altima
3. Magnolia Tree
4. Pothole
5. Propane Tank
6. BBQ Smoker Trailer
7. Shopping Cart
8. MATA Bus

These are enough to test movement, death, money, stealing, explosions, and counters.

Phase 1 Object Roles

Alien

Default player form.

Abilities:

- Walk
- Pick up one money stack
- Pick up one money bag slowly
- Touch nearby object to shapeshift
- Can be squished by vehicles
- Can respawn at landfill after death

Counters:

- Dies to Altima
- Dies to MATA Bus
- Dies to explosions
- Can hide inside small areas later, but not needed in Phase 1

Purpose:

- Default vulnerable form
 - Encourages shapeshifting for safety and utility
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Altima

Fast vehicle form.

Abilities:

- Moves fast
- Can carry one money bag
- Can squish aliens
- Can squish shopping carts
- Can squish small animals later
- Can steal loose money quickly

Weaknesses:

- Dies if it crashes into a tree
- Dies if it hits a pothole
- Dies if it hits a building
- Dies if it hits a propane tank explosion
- Dies if hit by MATA Bus

Purpose:

- Fun fast thief
 - Early chaos vehicle
 - Creates need for traps and counters
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Magnolia Tree

Slow ambush object.

Abilities:

- Moves extremely slowly
- Can block roads
- Kills/wrecks Altimas that crash into it
- Can hide near other trees
- Can protect money by standing near stash

Weaknesses:

- Very slow
- Cannot carry money
- Vulnerable to being ignored or avoided
- Later can be countered by chainsaw/lawn mower/fire, but not Phase 1

Purpose:

- Anti-vehicle trap
 - Funny because a moving tree is suspicious
 - Lets players ambush reckless drivers
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Pothole

Road trap form.

Abilities:

- Can move very slowly
- If an Altima drives over it, Altima dies/wrecks
- Can block roads
- Can guard money
- Can create funny surprise kills

Weaknesses:

- Cannot carry money
- Very slow
- Useless off-road
- MATA Bus may be immune or only slowed

Purpose:

- Direct counter to Altima
 - Encourages tactical placement
 - Funny Memphis-specific hazard
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Propane Tank

Innocent-looking explosive object.

Abilities:

- Can be carried or pushed slowly
- Explodes if hit by Altimas
- Explodes if hit by MATA Bus
- Explosion kills nearby aliens
- Explosion destroys or drops carried money from vehicles
- Explosion can knock money loose from stashes

Weaknesses:

- Cannot move fast
- Explosion kills the propane-tank player too if they are currently shapeshifted as it
- Can be avoided once noticed
- Should have a small delay or warning hiss before exploding

Purpose:

- Explosive anti-vehicle counter
- Funny trap object
- Makes players suspicious of innocent objects near roads

Important behavior:

- Propane tank should look normal until hit or activated.
- If a vehicle hits it, it should create a satisfying explosion.
- Explosion should not permanently destroy money. It should scatter/drop money.

BBQ Smoker Trailer

Money generator and smoke utility.

Abilities:

- Slowly generates money stacks when parked near houses or NPC crowd areas
- Can create smoke cloud
- Smoke cloud hides nearby players and money
- Can carry one money bag
- Can be towed later, but not required in Phase 1

Weaknesses:

- Slow
- Dies or breaks if hit by MATA Bus
- Explodes or catches fire if hit by propane explosion
- Vulnerable to Altimas theft if money is left nearby

Purpose:

- First money generator
 - Creates a reason to defend a spot
 - Smoke creates sneaky gameplay without needing a scanner
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Shopping Cart

Low-tier money transport.

Abilities:

- Can carry multiple money stacks
- Can carry one money bag
- Moves faster than alien but slower than Altimas
- Can be pushed into money to collect it
- Can be used to move loot from BBQ smoker to hiding spot

Weaknesses:

- Dies/squished by Altimas
- Dies/squished by MATA Bus
- Can be blocked by pothole/tree
- Cannot kill anything

Purpose:

- Starter transport object
 - Useful for non-aggressive players
 - Easy for new players to understand
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MATA Bus

Heavy vehicle form.

Abilities:

- Moves slower than Altimas
- Can crush Altimas
- Can crush aliens
- Can carry one vault
- Can carry several money bags
- Can push shopping carts
- Can block roads

Weaknesses:

- Slow turning
- Dies or stops if it crashes into a building
- Triggered propane explosions damage/kill it
- Cannot enter narrow areas
- Later countered by train/barge/large building

Purpose:

- Heavy transport
 - Counter to Altima
 - High-risk, high-reward loot hauler
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Phase 1 Money System

Implement physical money objects.

Money tiers

Tier 1: Money Stack

Smallest money object.

Rules:

- Alien can carry one.
- Shopping cart can carry several.
- Altima can carry several or one bag.
- Two money stacks combine into one money bag.

Tier 2: Money Bag

Rules:

- Created by combining two money stacks.
- Alien can carry one slowly.
- Shopping cart can carry one.
- Altima can carry one.
- MATA Bus can carry several.
- Two money bags combine into one vault.

Tier 3: Vault

Rules:

- Created by combining two money bags.
- Alien cannot carry vault.
- Shopping cart cannot carry vault.
- Altima cannot carry vault.
- MATA Bus can carry one vault.
- Vault has owner label.
- Vault can be stolen.

Do not implement higher tiers yet. Save for later.

Money Combining Rules

Money should combine when two matching objects are pushed or dropped close together.

Examples:

- Money Stack + Money Stack = Money Bag
- Money Bag + Money Bag = Vault

When combining:

- Play satisfying visual effect.
 - Stamp owner name on new money object.
 - If no owner exists, assign ownership to the player who completed the combine.
 - If money from different owners is combined, assign owner to the player who performed the final combine.
 - Combined money should be heavier and harder to move.
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Ownership Rules

Every combined money object should display a simple name when nearby.

Examples:

- Moe's Money Bag
- Taz's Vault
- Josh's Stolen Vault

Suggested Phase 1 behavior:

- Money stacks may be ownerless.
- Money bags and vaults should have owner labels.
- If another player picks up or loads your money, label changes to:
 - “Moe’s Money Bag — being stolen by Josh”
- If Josh carries it to his own stash zone or holds it for a set period, it becomes:
 - “Josh’s Stolen Money Bag”
- After more time, it becomes:
 - “Josh’s Money Bag”

For Phase 1, this can be simplified:

- Ownership changes immediately when a player successfully carries another player’s money to a basic claim zone.
- A claim zone can be a simple circular area near the player’s current stash.

Death Rules

No health bar.

Use instant death based on collision rules.

Phase 1 kill/collision matrix

Object A	Object B	Result
Altima	Alien	Alien dies
Altima	Shopping Cart	Shopping Cart player dies, cart drops money
Altima	Magnolia Tree	Altima dies
Altima	Pothole	Altima dies
Altima	Building/House	Altima dies
Altima	Propane Tank	Propane explodes, Altima dies
MATA Bus	Alien	Alien dies
MATA Bus	Shopping Cart	Shopping Cart player dies
MATA Bus	Altima	Altima dies
MATA Bus	Propane Tank	Propane explodes, bus dies or drops cargo
MATA Bus	Building/House	Bus dies or stops and drops cargo

Object A	Object B	Result
Propane Explosion	Alien	Alien dies
Propane Explosion	Altima	Altima dies
Propane Explosion	Shopping Cart	Cart dies/drops money
Propane Explosion	BBQ Smoker	Smoker catches fire/drops money
Propane Explosion	Money	Money scatters but is not destroyed
Tree	Alien	No kill
Pothole	Alien	No kill
Shopping Cart	Alien	No kill or mild bump only

When a player dies:

- Drop carried money.
- Respawn at landfill.
- Show quick funny death message:
- "You got Altima'd."
- "You became roadkill."
- "You challenged a tree and lost."
- "The pothole won."
- "Propane had other plans."
- "MATA said move."

Phase 1 Shapeshifting

Players shapeshift by touching a nearby object.

For prototype, keep mini-game very simple.

Simple implementation

When alien is near a shapeshiftable object:

- Show button: "Become"
- On tap, start 1-second interaction timer
- If player stays close, shapeshift succeeds
- Later replace this with DNA mini-game

Do not build complex DNA mini-game yet unless basic loop is fun.

Shapeshifting object behavior

When player becomes an object:

- The original object disappears from the world.
- The player model becomes that object.
- Player gains object movement and collision rules.
- Player can press “Pop Out” to return to alien form.
- When player pops out, the object reappears nearby.

If player dies as an object:

- Player respawns as alien at landfill.
 - Object respawns at its original spawn point or after delay.
 - Car forms may leave wreckage briefly.
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Phase 1 Controls

Mobile-friendly controls:

- Left thumb drag or virtual joystick: move
- Tap money/object: interact
- Button 1: pick up/drop
- Button 2: become object / shapeshift
- Button 3: pop out to alien form
- Button 4: special ability, if available

Phase 1 special abilities:

- BBQ Smoker: smoke cloud
- Propane Tank: optional manual “hiss”/arm ability
- MATA Bus: horn
- Altima: speed burst
- Pothole: flatten/hide
- Tree: root/block

Keep controls minimal.

Phase 1 Map

Use current small open world and add a few test zones.

Required areas

Landfill Spawn

Contains:

- Alien spawn point
- Starter objects
- Some money stacks
- Trash piles
- Clear exits

Neighborhood Road

Contains:

- Houses
- Trees
- Road
- Money stacks
- Altima spawn
- Pothole spawn
- Propane tank spawn

BBQ Corner

Contains:

- BBQ smoker
- Money generation area
- Parking lot
- Hiding spots

Bus Stop

Contains:

- MATA Bus spawn
- Road wide enough for bus
- Money bag/vault test area

Phase 1 Success Criteria

After building the prototype, we should test with a few local friends.

The prototype is successful if players naturally do these things without needing much explanation:

1. Laugh when someone gets squished.
2. Understand that Altima kills aliens.
3. Discover that tree/pothole/propane counter Altima.
4. Fight over money bags.
5. Combine money stacks into bigger money.
6. Try to steal another player's money.
7. Respawn and immediately seek revenge.
8. Use objects creatively.
9. Ask "what else can I become?"

If these happen, the core idea is working.

Phase 2: Expand Object Purpose and Counter System

After Phase 1 feels fun, expand the roster.

The goal of Phase 2 is to make each object feel like a clever tool.

Expanded Memphis Object Roster

Vehicles

Nissan Altima

Role:

- Fast thief
- Squishes aliens/small animals

Counters:

- Tree
- Pothole
- Propane tank
- MATA Bus
- Building
- Road cone cluster
- Traffic light

Purpose:

- Chaos vehicle and early aggression
-

Dodge Charger With Temp Tags

Role:

- Faster than Altima
- Stronger ram
- Worse turning

Counters:

- Pothole
- Propane tank
- Bus
- Building
- Spike strip if added later

Purpose:

- Riskier, funnier high-speed vehicle
-

MATA Bus

Role:

- Heavy transport
- Crushes cars
- Carries vaults

Counters:

- Propane tank
- Train
- Large building
- River/barge zone
- Roadblock cluster

Purpose:

- Heavy hauler and anti-car unit
-

Tow Truck

Role:

- Drags disabled cars
- Steals wrecked vehicles
- Moves vaults slowly

Counters:

- Bus
- Propane tank
- Pothole
- Tiger/human hijack ability later

Purpose:

- Theft support and cleanup vehicle
-

Church Van

Role:

- Carries multiple aliens or money bags
- Safe-ish group transport
- May protect carried aliens from being squished

Counters:

- Bus
- Propane tank
- Pothole
- Altima side impact

Purpose:

- Team transport
-

Food Truck

Role:

- Generates money when parked near crowds
- Stores money bags
- Attracts NPCs

Counters:

- Propane tank
- Tow truck
- Bus
- Health inspector NPC later

Purpose:

- Mobile economy unit
-

Graceland Tour Bus

Role:

- Generates tourist money
- Carries lots of NPCs/money
- Stronger economy than MATA Bus but weaker combat

Counters:

- Propane tank
- Traffic jam
- Roadblock
- Bus/large vehicle

Purpose:

- Big economy vehicle
-

Germantown Golf Cart

Role:

- Quiet scout
- Carries one money stack or small bag
- Low profile in suburbs

Counters:

- Altima
- Pothole
- Tiger
- Shopping cart swarm

Purpose:

- Sneaky suburban transport
-

Explosive / Trap Objects

Propane Tank

Role:

- Explodes when hit
- Anti-vehicle trap

Counters:

- Counters Altima, Charger, Bus, Food Truck
- Can be countered by careful driving, pushing, or triggering from distance

Purpose:

- Innocent-looking explosive trap
-

Southaven Firework Stand

Role:

- Explosive money generator
- Produces money from NPCs buying fireworks
- Can detonate if rammed

Counters:

- Kills cars, aliens, small animals nearby
- Countered by staying away or using water/firetruck later

Purpose:

- High-risk, high-reward economy trap
-

Gas Station Pump

Role:

- Generates small money from NPC cars

- Explodes if hit hard

Counters:

- Anti-car trap
- Countered by careful players

Purpose:

- Makes gas stations dangerous and valuable
-

BBQ Propane Grill

Role:

- Looks harmless
- Can be moved near roads/stashes
- Explodes smaller than propane tank

Counters:

- Anti-alien, anti-cart, anti-car

Purpose:

- Funny domestic explosive
-

Hot Wing Grease Barrel

Role:

- Slippery spill if hit
- Can ignite near fire/explosion

Counters:

- Makes vehicles lose control
- Combos with propane/fireworks

Purpose:

- Chain reaction comedy
-

FedEx Mystery Package

Role:

- Looks like normal package
- Can be a fake loot decoy
- May explode, slime, or scatter fake money

Counters:

- Counters thieves
- Countered by cautious pickup

Purpose:

- Trick item and anti-thief trap
-

Animals / Humans

Memphis Tiger

Role:

- Fast animal
- Kills humans/gangsters
- Can chase aliens but may not kill vehicles

Counters:

- Grizzlies Bear
- Altimas
- Bus
- Animal control van later

Purpose:

- Fast hunter
-

Grizzlies Bear

Role:

- Kills tigers
- Strong animal tank
- Scares humans/NPCs

Counters:

- Bus
- Train
- Tranquilizer NPC later
- Propane explosion

Purpose:

- Animal hierarchy counter
-

Orange Mound Pit Bull

Role:

- Fast guard/chaser
- Protects stash
- Chases aliens/humans

Counters:

- Car
- Bear
- Food distraction
- Fence/gate later

Purpose:

- Stash defense and chase unit
-

Peabody Duck

Role:

- Tiny stealth form
- Can enter small spaces
- Can steal tiny items

Counters:

- Tiger
- Car
- Human capture
- River current

Purpose:

- Tiny infiltrator
-

Overton Park Squirrel

Role:

- Tiny thief
- Steals money stacks only
- Very fast and annoying

Counters:

- Cat/dog/tiger
- Car
- Tree trap maybe safe zone

Purpose:

- Low-value harassment
-

Human / Gangster NPC

Role:

- Can carry money bag
- May threaten aliens
- Blends into city

Counters:

- Tiger kills human
- Car squishes human
- Police/security NPC later

Purpose:

- Human disguise and mid-tier carrier
-

Elvis Impersonator

Role:

- Attracts tourist NPCs
- Generates small money
- Distracts humans

Counters:

- Tiger
- Car
- Heckler NPC later

Purpose:

- Tourist economy/distraction
-

Buildings / Landmarks

Bass Pro Pyramid

Role:

- Massive storage and income
- Very slow
- Almost impossible to move practically

Counters:

- Cannot chase
- Vulnerable to theft because it is obvious
- Plane crash could damage/drop loot later

Purpose:

- Endgame flex object
-

Gas Station LED Sign

Role:

- Attracts NPC cars
- Generates money
- Can redirect traffic

Counters:

- Car crash
- Propane/gas pump chain explosion
- Tow truck can move sign later

Purpose:

- Traffic economy generator
-

Liberty Bowl Stadium

Role:

- Generates event-money bursts
- Attracts crowds
- Stores lots of money

Counters:

- Huge and obvious
- Slow/no movement
- Crowd chaos attracts thieves

Purpose:

- Event-based economy landmark
-

BBQ Restaurant

Role:

- Generates steady food money
- Stores bags/vaults
- Attracts NPCs

Counters:

- Fire/explosion
- Food truck competition
- Tow truck cannot move it

Purpose:

- Static economy base
-

FedEx Warehouse

Role:

- Generates packages/money
- Great for hiding FedEx box players
- Spawns delivery vehicles

Counters:

- High traffic
- Package thieves
- Explosive mystery packages

Purpose:

- Logistics money zone
-

Objects / Utility

FedEx Box Pile

Role:

- Hiding form
- Can store small money
- Blends near warehouse

Counters:

- Forklift
- Fire/explosion
- Thief can inspect up close

Purpose:

- Stealth stash
-

Kroger Parking Lot Cart

Role:

- Starter loot transport
- Can push money stacks/bags
- Swarm harassment

Counters:

- Altima
- Bus
- Pothole
- Shopping cart corral trap

Purpose:

- Beginner hauler
-

Road Cone

Role:

- Blocks/redirects vehicles
- Can create roadblock clusters

Counters:

- Bus can push through
- Alien can move it
- Altima can break through at risk

Purpose:

- Cheap road control
-

Malfunctioning Traffic Light

Role:

- Stops/confuses vehicles
- Creates traffic jams
- Protects stash near roads

Counters:

- Pedestrians/animals ignore it
- Bus may push through
- Power outage later

Purpose:

- Vehicle control
-

Railroad Crossing Arm

Role:

- Blocks roads
- Traps cars
- Combos with train later

Counters:

- Bus can break it
- Alien can sneak around
- Explosion can destroy it

Purpose:

- Traffic trap
-

I-240 Exit Sign

Role:

- Confuses vehicle pathing/NPC cars
- Redirects traffic toward traps

Counters:

- Stationary
- Can be ignored by player-controlled vehicles

Purpose:

- Funny traffic manipulation
-

Manhole Cover

Role:

- Opens underground shortcuts
- Hides small money
- Lets aliens/ducks/squirrels escape

Counters:

- Heavy vehicles cannot use it
- Can be blocked by car/tree/object

Purpose:

- Escape and stealth route
-

Long-Term Persistent World Rules

Because the game is live forever, the world needs soft cleanup.

Implement later:

- Abandoned loose money slowly gets swept toward landfill.
 - Wrecked cars despawn after a delay.
 - Key objects respawn if missing too long.
 - Offline players remain as sleeping alien/object.
 - Other players can move sleeping aliens.
 - Other players can evict offline players from object forms after a delay.
 - Important stashes become discoverable through world gossip if left unguarded too long.
 - The landfill periodically spawns random starter junk.
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Recommended Development Order

Step 1: Collision + death

Implement:

- Collision between players and objects
- Altimia kills alien
- Altimia dies to tree/building
- Respawn at landfill
- Drop carried money on death

This tests the basic comedy.

Step 2: Shapeshifting

Implement:

- Become object
- Pop out of object
- Object disappears while player is shapeshifted
- Object respawns when player leaves form/dies

Start with:

- Alien
- Altima
- Tree
- Pothole
- Propane tank

Step 3: Money

Implement:

- Money stacks
- Pick up/drop
- Combine 2 stacks into bag
- Bag ownership label
- Stealing bag
- Drop money on death

Step 4: Transport

Implement:

- Shopping cart carries multiple stacks
- Altima carries one bag
- MATA Bus carries one vault
- Combine 2 bags into vault

Step 5: Explosion

Implement:

- Propane tank explodes when hit by vehicle
- Explosion kills nearby aliens
- Explosion destroys vehicles
- Explosion scatters money but does not destroy it

Step 6: Money generator

Implement:

- BBQ smoker generates money stacks every few seconds when parked
- Smoke ability hides nearby money/players visually

Step 7: Playtest

Test with 3–5 players.

Observe:

- Do they understand what killed them?
- Do they laugh?
- Do they try revenge?
- Do they understand money combining?
- Do they use tree/pothole/propane to counter Altimas?
- Do they naturally steal?
- Do they ask for more objects?

Only expand after this.

First Prototype Object Counter Matrix

Use this as the first balance pass.

Object/Form	Purpose	Kills / Counters	Countered By
Alien	Default, collects small money	Nothing directly	Altima, Bus, Explosion
Altima	Fast thief, squishes aliens	Alien, Shopping Cart	Tree, Pothole, Propane, Bus, Building
Tree	Anti-car ambush	Altima, Charger later	Slow, cannot carry money
Pothole	Road trap	Altima, Charger later	Useless off-road, Bus may resist
Propane Tank	Explosive trap	Vehicles, aliens nearby	Careful avoidance, triggers self-death
BBQ Smoker	Money generator, smoke cover	Hides money/players	Bus, Explosion, Theft
Shopping Cart	Starter hauler	Carries money	Altima, Bus
MATA Bus	Heavy hauler, anti-car	Alien, Altima, Cart	Propane, Building, later Train
Money Stack	Basic loot	Combines into bag	Can be stolen
Money Bag	Medium loot	Combines into vault	Can be stolen

Object/Form	Purpose	Kills / Counters	Countered By
Vault	Heavy loot	Stores value	Needs Bus/Tow Truck

Design Philosophy

This game should be easy to understand but hard to fully master.

A non-gamer should understand:

- Get money.
- Become objects.
- Don't get hit.
- Hide your money.
- Steal other people's money.

A gamer should discover:

- Propane traps.
- Tree ambushes.
- Pothole road control.
- Money transport strategy.
- Object ownership theft.
- Counter-object chains.
- Persistent revenge tactics.

The fun comes from emergent stories, not complex menus.

Example stories we want players to tell:

- "I stole Josh's vault with a bus, but Moe was hiding as a pothole and wrecked me."
 - "Taz turned into a tree and baited three Altimas into crashing."
 - "Somebody hid propane tanks around the BBQ smoker and blew up everyone trying to steal from it."
 - "I logged back in and someone had moved my alien body into a shopping cart."
 - "A FedEx box followed me for two blocks and stole my money bag."
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Do Not Build Yet

Avoid these until the core prototype is fun:

- Full DNA mini-game
- Large map
- Dozens of units

- Complex economy
- Skill trees
- Cosmetics
- Matchmaking
- Endgame landmarks
- Offline eviction system
- Flying units
- NPC crowds
- Advanced AI
- Permanent progression
- Real-money monetization

First prove the basic chaos is fun.

Final Prototype Goal

The first playable prototype should answer one question:

Is it fun for 3–5 people to run around as aliens, become Memphis objects, steal physical money, and kill/counter each other in stupid funny ways?

If yes, expand the object roster and persistent-world systems.

If no, simplify further until the moment-to-moment interaction is funny.